Pakistan being on the brink of destruction should acknowledge their mistakes. Unlike in 2008, the TTP no longer poses a threat to conquering a large part of the country.

However, as both Mr Elahi and I have written, Pakistanis also need to understand that victory against insurgency does not mean an end to terrorism, even if terrorism has been considerably reduced from its former heights. Tragically, and as we can see in Europe today, terrorist networks have become so widespread and simple terrorist weapons are so easy to procure that both Pakistan and the West will have to endure this menace for a very long time.

Both Islamic and Western countries must develop long-term strategies that combine toughness and restraint and, whenever possible, prioritise effective police and intelligence tactics over military rules. It is also essential to shape a public opinion that will be resilient to terrorist attacks and resolute in its response. This book is an invaluable contribution to this effort by Pakistan.

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